

Samantha B. Kane

samantha_kane@brown.edu | samanthabkane.github.io

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Research Associate, Annenberg Institute, Brown University	2025–
Visiting Scholar, Harvard Graduate School of Education	2025–

EDUCATION

Harvard University

Ph.D., Education Policy and Program Evaluation 2025
Thesis: “Essays on Human Capital Investment Decisions: K-12, Higher Education, and the Labor Market”
Committee: Martin West (Chair), Susan Dynarski, David Deming

M.P.P., Harvard Kennedy School 2021

Princeton University

A.B., School of Public and International Affairs (*with honors*) 2013

PUBLICATIONS & FORTHCOMING PAPERS

Kane, Samantha B. (2026). “The Price of Helping Others: Altruistic Preferences and the Gender Wage Gap.” *Research in Higher Education*, 67, Article 47. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11162-026-09903-8>

WORKING PAPERS

Kane, Samantha B. (2025). “In the Wake of *Dobbs*: The Effect of State Abortion Bans on Women’s College Choices”. (EdWorkingPaper: 25-1126). <https://doi.org/10.26300/84r6-8x28> [*R&R, Journal of Human Resources*]

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Changing Choice Sets: How Parents Respond to Increases in Access to High-Quality Schools”

“Public Policy and the Geographic Distribution of Skilled Labor” (with Derek Rury)

“Tech Boom or Bust? The Effect of Data Center Expansion on Student Achievement” (with Matthew Kraft and Christopher Cleveland)

“The Hidden Erosion of Time in School” (with Matthew Kraft, Jessica Cobian, and Meghan Sellars)

RESEARCH GRANTS

Brown University Division of Research Research Resilience Award (Co-PI) 2025
Project: *Tech Boom or Bust? The Effect of Data Center Expansion on Student Achievement*
Total Award: \$70,000

Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Grant (PI) 2024
Project: *In the Wake of Dobbs: The Effect of State Abortion Bans on Women’s College Choices*

Total Award: \$10,000

Harvard Graduate School of Education Doctoral Research Grant (PI) 2022
Project: *The Price of Helping Others: Altruistic Preferences and the Gender Wage Gap*
Total Award: \$1,465

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Women and Public Policy Program Research Fellowship, Harvard Kennedy School	2024–2025
Emerging Education Policy Scholar (EEPS), Thomas B. Fordham Institute and AEI	2023
Partnering in Education Research (PIER) Fellowship, IES and Harvard University	2020–2023
Program in Education Policy and Governance Fellowship, Harvard Kennedy School	2018–2021
Presidential Scholar, Harvard University	2019
Rappaport Public Policy Fellowship, Harvard Kennedy School	2019
Janet M. McCartney Scholar, Princeton University	2013
Donald Stokes '51 Dean's Prize, Princeton University	2013

INVITED TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

Kane, Samantha B., Matthew A. Kraft, and Christopher Cleveland. “Tech Boom or Bust? The Effect of Data Center Expansion on Student Achievement.”

ASSA Annual Meeting (<i>forthcoming</i>)	2027
Oregon State University (<i>forthcoming</i>)	2026
Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness Annual Conference	2026
SustainableED Conference, Annenberg Institute, Brown University	2026

Kane, Samantha B. “The Price of Helping Others: Altruistic Preferences and the Gender Wage Gap.”

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management	2025
Association for Education Finance and Policy	2025

Kane, Samantha B. “In the Wake of *Dobbs*: The Effect of State Abortion Bans on Women's College Choices.”

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management	2024
Council of Economic Advisors, Executive Office of the President	2024
Office of the Chief Economist, U.S. Department of Education	2024
CESifo / ifo Junior Workshop on the Economics of Education	2024
Association for Education Finance and Policy	2024
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management	2023

Kane, Samantha B. “Changing Choice Sets: How Parents Respond to Increases in Access to High-Quality Schools”.

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management	2023
Association for Education Finance and Policy	2022

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

A164/API211: Program Evaluation and Education Policy	2022–2024
Teaching Fellow for Tom Kane, Harvard Graduate School of Education	

EVI101: Evidence	2023
Teaching Fellow for Martin West, Harvard Graduate School of Education	

EPA 101: Politics and Education Policy Teaching Fellow for Martin West, Harvard Graduate School of Education	2021
API 102Z: Economic Analysis of Public Policy Teaching Fellow for Jeffrey Liebman, Harvard Kennedy School	2020–2021

PRIOR EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, <i>Education Next</i> Harvard Kennedy School	2019–2025
Research Assistant, Center for Education Policy Research Harvard University	2019–2020
Policy Analyst/Senior Policy Analyst, Education, K-12 Center for American Progress	2015–2018
Confidential Assistant, Office of Elementary and Secondary Education U.S. Department of Education	2014–2015

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & ACTIVITIES

Referee

American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Education Economics, Economics of Education Review, Journal of Public Economics, Quarterly Journal of Economics

Conference Activities

Discussant: Association for Public Policy and Management (2025, 2026)
Session Organizer: Association for Public Policy and Management (2025, 2024)

Professional Memberships

American Economic Association, Association for Public Policy and Management, Association for Education Finance and Policy

MEDIA CITATIONS

Culture Study, Hechinger Report, The 74, Wall Street Journal